

Project Report Out!

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Project Sponsor (Our Professor)

Dr. Tim Maciag

Business need/Opportunity

- SSCF need a centralized hub to serve Saskatchewan Charities
- User-Friendly Navigation

There should be no problem accessing the website and all links. We need a better hub with easy access to all materials

- Updated Data & Information

The data should also be up to date, with all new information from charities, webinars, and other events. We need a large, easily visible, monthly or weekly updated website containing all new and old information

- Community Engagement and Collaboration

There should be opportunities to learn with others and work with others to help fund charities. We need a dedicated spot for those who want to collaborate with charities and other people

- Consistent Tracking and Layout

The information should always be easy to see and read, and consistent with all information needed at once. We need a place where there is a clean number of links and only important information

- Statistics

There should be ways to help others identify the greater impact others and the charities have made. We need consistent charts, images, and numbers of things such as events held, and total money invested

Reflections on Project Planning, Execution, and Closing

North Star Customers:

Saskatchewan-based charitable organizations looking for structured, easily accessible resources to support their operations and planning.

Carryover Customers:

Community members or donors seeking guidance on how to interact with and support local charities. This includes donation instructions, volunteering, and transparency resources.

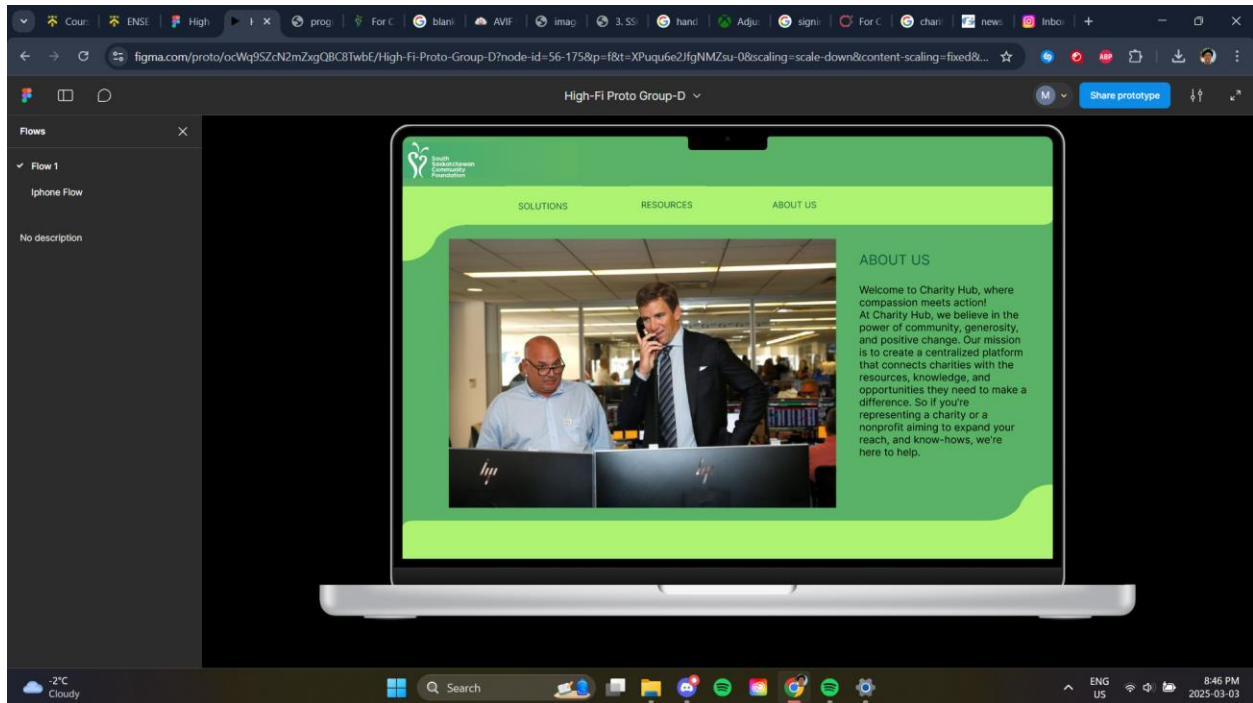
SSCF business partners that offer services to charities in areas of marketing and branding, Legal and governance, and accounting.

SSCF staff are part of the carryover customers

The purpose of the project is to create an add-on to the already existing South Saskatchewan Community Foundation website. The common goal is to organize the information on the original website in a way that is more understandable and easier to access, where it is a Charity Resource Hub, for information and learning.

Now the website we have designed has been edited and played with a lot based on the things we created on Figma and what we could actually accomplish in WordPress. We had a lot of time to work and develop on the look of the website and the overall feel, with the colors and the guidelines provided, as well as the color palette. Now originally, our website needed a lot of work, and a lot of it had to be changed from the first meeting to our final presentation, and so we did as much as we could, with all the customer insights we were given.

Firstly, one of the big things we had to worry about in the first meeting was really looking at what we could/should do and or add on our website, and what wasn't necessary. From our low-fidelity prototype, we had a lot more information and work coming into it than we needed. We had originally wanted to add sections for things like Volunteering, Donations, and Ticket Booking, as well as other buckets, where we thought of it as a needed addition to the website, and we didn't understand what the true problem was. There was also a lot of discussion with what we could have done better with our website, and at times we fell flat in giving what we could have as a team, with creating other versions of our website, rather than focusing on one. This ended with us not having as much information on our website during the Figma phase, where the customer and the sponsor said our website pages had focused more on the images, rather than the information. As well, at this point in our website, we had trouble differentiating the website from the original SSCF website, and so that made a big difference later on, giving us exactly what they wanted, clear as day.



Text

In addition to our images, the customer had said that our text, both the scale of them and the font and color that we originally needed was not what they had wanted, and it was too large at times. They said they we have to remember to make things smaller, and work towards a better, more condensed website, where there is more information in a smaller size. Furthermore, some of the text we had originally added on the website was unnecessary and out of scope for what they wanted, pushing the work we had backwards, and helping us redirect our focus onto remembering our insights & needs.

Affordances

With affordances, we originally had not considered them very much

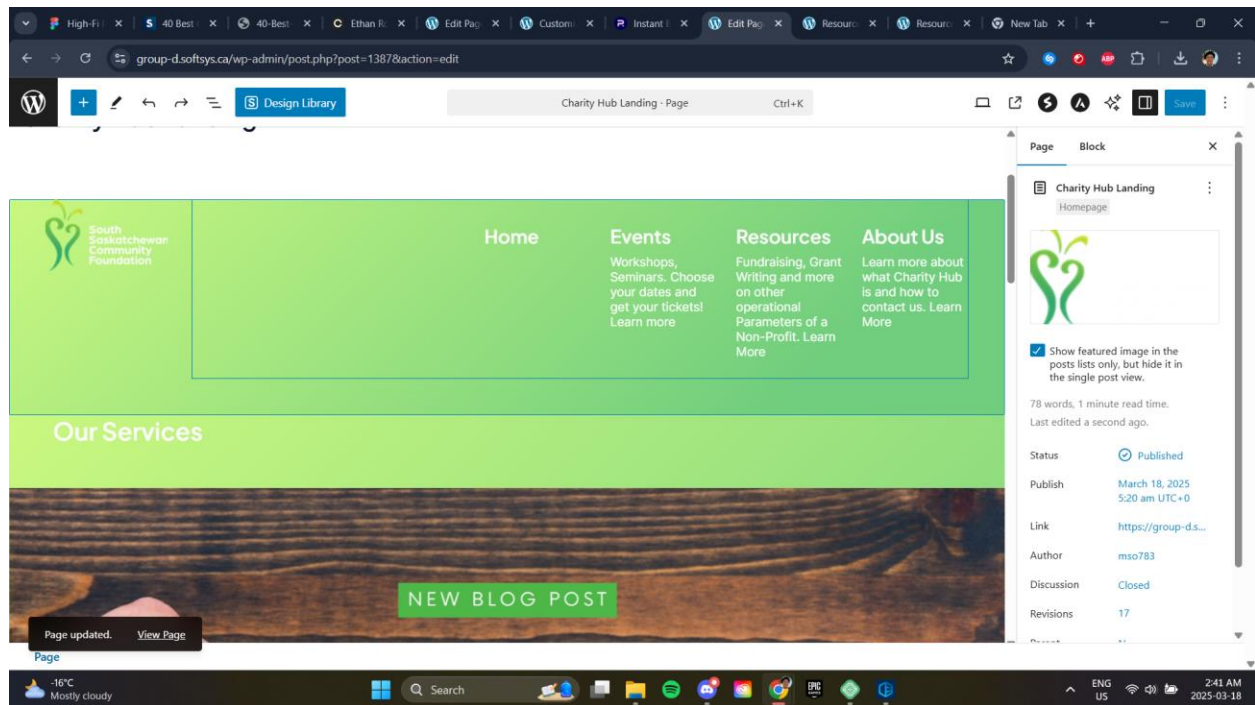
Gestalt Theory

We grouped related items in the menu, this concept was also employed in several pages where related topics only appear together.

Content

Removing Content based on Volunteering & Donations

Navigation & Forward Changing Website



We needed more concise and clear website details, like changing the names of our links and names, such as reworking Resources and changing our original name for Opportunities.

We need to guide the users and others better as in how to get to our website and how to make it function

Linking it back to the SSCF

We have to make sure other than the fact that this is a different website, that we have to be able to redirect back to the SSCF easily

Work towards a better design in terms of color and the background, as well as the images, change how some of them look, work towards changing the work, some of the color scheme used in the website wasn't used enough

Take some of the content from our website and get rid of it because there are some things that are not needed, and are redundant, because we are just giving things that the SSCF already have at this point, and it takes away from their own website.

We gathered more information by presenting it to them, but we could have given them more leeway into actually playing around with our website and the information we had instead of just displaying it

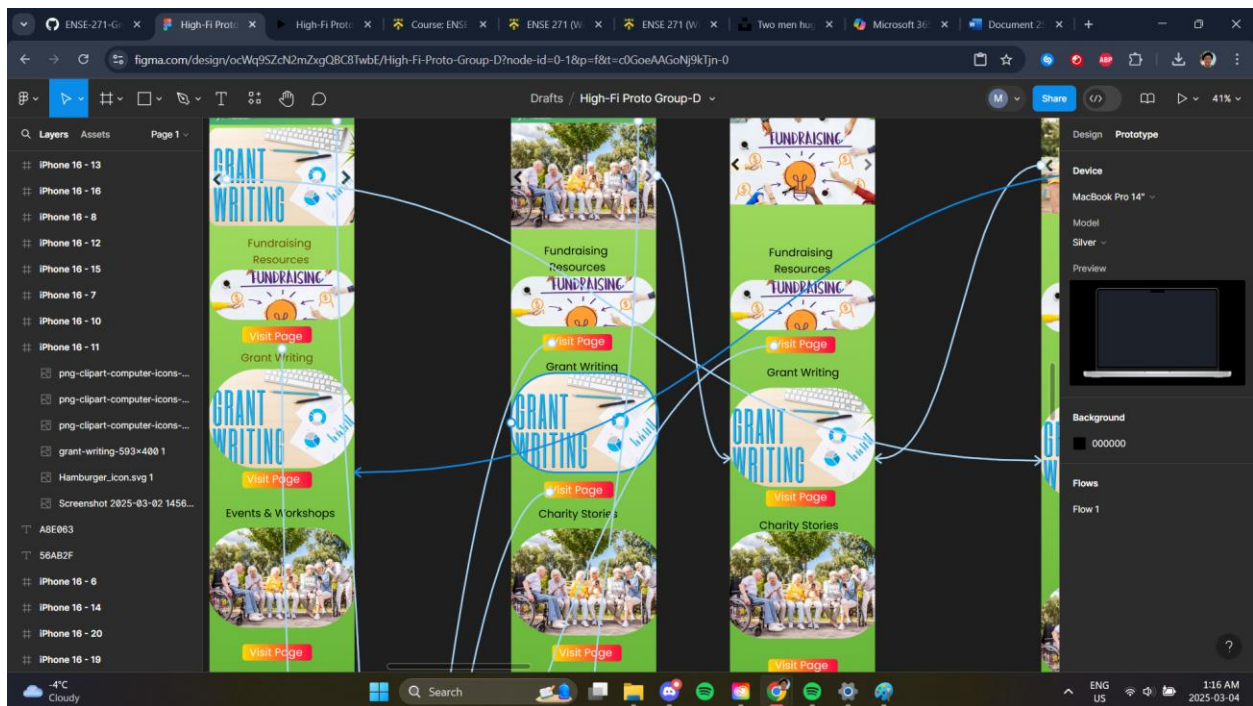
Find a way to balance the text and image

Differentiating between the charity hub and SSCF Site:

1. Use of layout, colour and imagery so that a switch is noticeable in the colour, background colour and layout.
2. Use of Constraint and feedback to ensure user is aware of navigation:

To ensure users are aware of switch between the charity hub and sscf site, we can employ constraint and feedback concepts. for example when a user clicks the button that takes you to the sscf site, a constraint prevents immediate switch, and a feedback pops up "are you sure you want to switch from the charity Hub to SSCF" users are allowed to Click YES or NO depending on their need.

3. Use of sound feedback: a voice play that tells the user of the switch.



Successfulness:

- We were not that successful in transferring out prototype from Figma to WordPress, mainly because of all of the constraints that we had found, from adjusting the text to the navigation bar, to some of the images, it was really hard to understand why WordPress does not allow or do some of the most basic things.
- As for working as a team, we really struggled in finding time to meet and work with each other towards getting the website done, and a lot of the time, we worked on it on our own without each other's input, which lead to a lot of things not being consistent, or worth it to present at times
- As for the people centered designs and all the things course related that were taught, they definitely helped, and in some parts, even got us to discover more options that were available, more things that can be done
- For what I would do different, one of the things is definitely pushing for a better product overall, looking at working on it more, as to see to it a better product. We would as a team, have more on our pages so we can gain more criticism across all activities
- For what I would do the same, it would have to be the design and the road we took to get there, I felt like our design was strong, even though some of the things we had were lacking
- Opportunities & Support for future design work has to do a lot with what others did as well, looking at how they did things to make ours better, taking inspiration and direct material from them. As well, we would push out more of a design and reform it more for the people and those who are willing to donate and such, I felt like a couple things we had were still unnecessary.

Contributions

- Maheen Siddique :

- ✎ Created Figma mobile prototype
- ✎ Designed 4 of the 5 main resource subpages (Fundraising, Marketing, Storytelling, and Governance) on the final WordPress site.
- ✎ Drew Site Map.
- ✎ Edited and refined User Story Map (USM) based on feedback progress.

- € Contributed significantly to team documentation:
- ¢ Developed content for the UR Courses Wiki
 - ¢ Filled content for GitHub repository landing page
- € Created empathy maps to inform user-centered design decisions.
- € Team Presentation slides.

Marc Aplao

- € I made sure to check after everything that they did, I made sure to contribute as well, adding things like Gestalt theory and fixing any colour coordination, things such as links and making sure they work, as well as telling people what they need to do, what they can do better. I also did a lot in making sure the content we have is necessary and is not redundant, how a lot of the work is centered around our website and reflects us more than anything.
- € I also made the figma, and the prototypes, in which we were able to use, and i edited almost everything they did, looking at their USM and Sitemap, telling them what is needed and what isn't
- € I was the person who told everyone what they needed to do, and what could be done better

Adai Yisah

- € [Add your specific contributions here — e.g., content writing, presentation design, feedback summaries, etc.]

WORD PRESS THEME AND PLUGINS:

1. **NAME:** - Astra WordPress

Attribute	Details
User Rating	5,700+ five-star reviews
Last Updated	April 8, 2025

Active Installations	1 million+
Key Purpose	Starter template and responsiveness
Why Chosen	Light weight and highly customizable and It offers special features and templates so it works perfectly with all page builders like Spectra, Elementor, Beaver Builder, etc. Fast performance, clean code, mobile-first design

2. NAME: - Twenty-Twenty five

Attribute	Details
User Rating	3.7 out of 5 stars
Last Updated	February 11, 2025
Active Installations	800,000+
Key Purpose	Full site editing, typography and design tools
Why Chosen	Twenty Twenty-Five emphasizes simplicity and adaptability. It offers flexible design options, supported by a variety of patterns for different page types, such as services and landing pages, making it ideal for building personal blogs, professional portfolios, online magazines, or business websites.

Plugin
 List:

#	Plugin Name	Rating	Last Updated	Active Installs	Purpose & Key Features	Saskatchewan-Specific Use
1	Akismet Anti-spam	4.5 star (3,200+ ratings)	May 2024	5M+	Blocks spam comments/form submissions using AI. Integrates with WPForms.	Protects charity contact forms from bot submissions.

2	AMP	4.3 star (1,800+ ratings)	Apr 2024	1M+	Creates mobile-optimized pages with fast loading.	Improves rural access with low-bandwidth compatibility.
3	Elementor	4.8 star(12,000+ ratings)	Jun 2024	10M+	Drag-and-drop page builder with 100+ widgets.	Used to design fundraising toolkit landing pages.
4	Duplicate Page	4.6 star (4,500+ ratings)	Mar 2024	800K+	Clones pages/posts with one click.	Rapidly replicates grant application templates.
5	Customizer Export/Import	4.7star (1,200+ ratings)	Feb 2024	300K+	Backs up and migrates theme customizations.	Preserves branding when transferring between dev stages.
6	Smart Slider 3	4.8star (2,100+ ratings)	May 2024	900K+	Creates responsive sliders/carousels. Supports videos.	Highlights success stories on homepage.
7	Spectra	4.9 star (5,700+ ratings)	Jun 2024	2M+	Gutenberg blocks library with prebuilt templates.	Accelerates resource page layouts (e.g., toolkits grid).